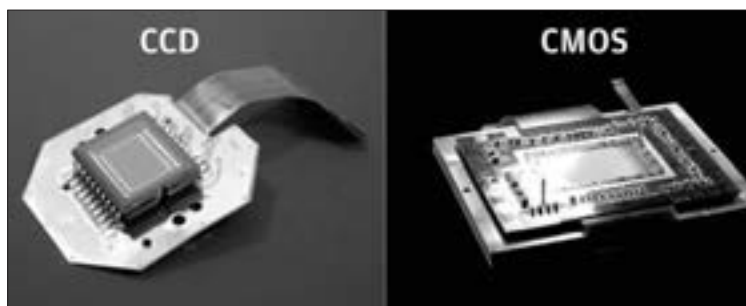


1.3 Selecting a Digital Camera

There are various factors that come to mind when buying a digital camera. When you're investing thousands of rupees for a camera, you want to make sure you don't buy a model that doesn't really suit your purpose or is much too advanced for your requirements. We have listed a few pointers that may assist you in making the right buying decision.

CCD Or CMOS?

CCD and CMOS are the two types of image sensors used in digital cameras. Cameras with CCD sensors are recommended over CMOS plainly because the image quality is tremendously better in the former. Though CMOS lenses are significantly cheaper to manufacture and easier to implement than CCDs, the difference in image quality is simply passable.



A CCD sensor (left) and a CMOS sensor (right)

CMOS sensors are extremely portable and require considerably lesser battery power—precisely why their most common application is in webcams and phone cams. All examples in this book are based on consumer cameras and are hence referring to CCD-sensor cameras unless otherwise mentioned.

The Price Factor

The price for a decent 3-megapixel digital camera can start at around Rs 6,500 and can go to well and above Rs 50,000 for a 7-plus megapixel model. Features vary from one model to another. While some low-end cameras offer complete manual control for amateur photographers who wish to experiment, some stick to the strict point-and-click norm.